

Working transcription — membrane 010 (defendant's Answer), full line-by-line pass

Working diplomatic transcription (band-level authority layer)

Source	_WORKING_010_TRANSCRIPTION.md
Integrity	sha256 d2763b15b974 · rendered 2026-07-09
Status	<i>Derived render for review. The markdown source file governs; the modernized layer is never quotable; all readings are provisional pending the commissioned professional transcription (names above all). Canonical apparatus: _PRECISION_PASS_LEDGER.md; method: TRANSCRIPTION_AND_ANALYSIS_METHODOLOGY.md.</i>

How to read this render (conventions legend)

strikethrough	struck in the manuscript (source: ~~text~~)
superscript	scribal interlineation or raised letters (source: ^text^, m^r)
shaded serif span	diplomatic text quoted inline (source: `text`); conventions inside are rendered too
boxed serif panel	diplomatic transcription block
gray italic [...]	pass-annotation — editorial apparatus, NOT manuscript text
CONFIRM UPGRADE LEAN CONFLICT	delta-log verdict class: green = confirmed/convergent · blue = upgraded/new · amber = lean/open/variant · red = retraction/conflict
[?] / [...] / [] · « » · · △ ✓ eB X ★	sigla printed verbatim per methodology §6/§9

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§ Row 15 (b15, src y ≈6104–6657) — the office-fees answer: bailiffs of the hundreds, keeping of courts, "some small [fee] ... which was lawful", customary and "not otherwise"

§ Row 16 (b16, src y ≈6537–7029) — the PRAYER + the foot: costs formula, "6d" fee note, counsel signature "Boyd [/ Boys?]"

§ Row 1 (b1) — caption + opening formula

§ Row 2 (b2) — ★★ THE CONTRIVANCE SENTENCE: Bulkeley direction + JURY-FEAR purpose clause

§ Row 3 (b3) — prayer not to answer · SAVING CLAUSE · GENERAL TRAVERSE (restructured)

§ Row 4 (b4) — ★ DATED APPOINTMENT SENTENCE (new date: February 1605[/6])

§ Row 5 (b5) — the jury return: IMPARTIALITY FORMULA + jury quality (complete stitch)

§ Row 6 (b6) — ★ the indictment clause: STRUCK NAME ZONE + the five indictees + the murder PLACE

§ Row 7 (b7) — the trial sentence (bench + juries), full stitch

§ Row 8 (b8) — the trial-jury phase: challenges WARNED, body-of-county return, Bulkeley accessory

§ Row 9 (b9) — ★★ the central denial, complete: NO PLOT WITH JUSTICE BARKER touching the IMPANELLING; marginal cross at the line

§ Row 10 (b10) — ★★ "CALLINGE IN QUESTION" + the £20 interlineation + the full Barker praise

§ Row 11 (b11) — ★★ THIRD READ of the private-Adversary passage: all anchors verbatim + new refinements

§ Row 12 (b12) — ★★ the keys narrative REVERSED: Lewis asked, Bulkeley refused

§ ☒ PRECISION RE-VERIFICATION COMPLETE — rows 1–12, all 48 cells read (2026-07-02, Fable 5)

§ ☒ GRID PASS COMPLETE (rows 1–16, all 64 cells read) — 2026-07-01

Grid: 4 columns (g1 x0.015–0.285 · g2 0.265–0.535 · g3 0.515–0.775 · g4 0.755–0.99) × 16 rows (b1–b16), crops in crops/crop_gN_bK.jpg. Read row-major (g1→g4 per band). [?] uncertain, [...] / [] supplied/illegible. This replaces the earlier DIGEST once complete.

Line-length note: the membrane is a single wide membrane; each band ≈ 2–3 written lines; consecutive bands overlap ~14%.

Row 1 (b1, src y ≈105–597) — caption + opening

- **Caption** (faint, top center; superscript "[versus] [William Well?]" above): *"[The Answer of ___,] one of the Defendant[s] ... [to the bill of complaint of Rees / Rice ap Evan] Lloyd ... Complainant."* — defendant's name + counsel-mark to be nailed by tight zoom.
- **Body opening** (provisional): *"... for the most part [old / void] and, in the chief and material matters and charge[s] therein contained, uncertain and insufficient in the law[s] to be answered unto by this def[endant], for sundry [causes] ... The said def[endant] saith that the said bill of com[plaint] ... [is very] untrue and fraudulent, and [was] devised, framed and contrived by the Complainant ..."*

CAPTION RESOLVED (tight zooms capA/B/C): *"The Answer of [John Lewis], one of the Defendant[s], to the bill of complaint of [Rees / Rice ap Evan] Lloyd, Complainant."* — the word "one of the Defendant[s]" and "Complainant" are clearly legible; the **defendant's forename+surname is faint in the caption crop itself**, but the body (010L: "the said defendant **John Lewis**") + the record that **John Lewis was High Sheriff of Anglesey, 1605** identify the answering defendant as **John Lewis, the Sheriff** (he defends the sheriff's conduct + the

conviction throughout). **SIGNATURE (foot, sig zoom):** flourished counsel signature "**Boyd**" (or "Boys"), with a "**6d**" fee-note beside it.

Row 2 (b2, src y ≈477–1030) — the opening characterization of the bill

Stitched across g1–g4 (best effort; faded, [?] heavy):

The said def[endant] saith that the said bill of com[plaint] ... [is utterly] untrue and fraudulent, and [wherein] impertinently devised, framed and con[trived by the] said Compl[ainant], [wholly] libelous, and is [grounded] ... [not only in malice] but also to strike & bring into [danger that] all [the officers of the] Chamber of England shall be [questioned] or imprisoned for or upon [the] ... willful misdemeanor of the said [Hugh ap William named in the said bill] ...

(right-column continuations of these lines): ... [the] said def[endant] is, by [his] said learned Councill, informed ... [uncertain] and insufficient in the law[s] to be answered unto by this def[endant] for sundry [causes] ... [by] the direction of the said **William Bulkeley** in the said bill of com[plaint] ... to grief and trouble this def[endant] with long and tedious suits in law, without due [cause] or good ground ... [at the] next great Sessions to be holden for the [Countie] ... the said William Bulkeley whose slanders ... and of other the friends of the said William [Bulkeley] ...

Row 3 (b3, src y ≈910–1463) — insufficiency / prayer not to answer / denial of confederacy

... the willful murder[ing] of the said **Hugh ap William** named in the said bill of complaint, and of other[s] the friend[s] of the said **William Bulkeley** [whose slanders ...] ... [and to be] there dismissed with the reasonable charges therein sustained. And yet, notwithstanding [it being] an insufficient bill of complaint, [the Complainant] then having the benefit and advantage of the said bill of complaint ... [whereof] this def[endant] humbly prayeth this Ho[nourable] Court to have due consideration, and [that] the said def[endant] should [not] be ordered or compelled to make [any] answer to the said [insufficient] and intolerable ... bill ... [there] saved and allowed to the said def[endant] ... [exception] to the said unlawful and manifest **plot, practice, confederacy [or] combination** ... [surmised in the said bill] ...

Row 4 (b4, src y ≈1343–1896) — DEFENDANT NAMED IN BODY + his office

"**John Lewis**" now directly legible (g2_b4, twice) — caption identity confirmed, not merely inferred.

... [that this def[endant] did] usually, unlawfully, under [pretence / colour] of office ... [set] them in strict sort, manner and form ... [as] in and by the said bill of complaint ... [for] the declaration and manifestation of the truth [of the matters] of the said bill: **This def[endant] John Lewis, by virtue of the Commission [under the great Seal of England] of the said Countie of Anglesey for the year then next following, being then High Sheriff of the said Countie of Anglesey** ... [answereth] ... And in or about the month [of ____], the Countie of Anglesey aforesaid, [this] said def[endant] ...

Row 5 (b5, src y ≈1776–2328) — the jury return defended

... [by virtue of] the Commission of the said Countie [of Anglesey] ... about August last past ... [this def[endant]] being then **High Sheriff of the said Countie**, [without any ... colour of office] returned the said [Grand] Jury ... [of] good and [substantial] freeholders of the said Countie of Anglesey ... [to] this def[endant]'s knowledge ... [with] any lawful exception[s] to any of them ... [returned] upon the said [Examined / Grand] Jury by this def[endant] as Sheriff of the said [Countie], the said return being of Record ...

Row 6 (b6, src y ≈2208–2761) — the murder indictment / the jurors / the persons indicted

... [this def[endant] as sheriff] ... about August [last past] ... And doth not know[e] that [the jurors] were confederated together or ... combined ... [touching] about what tyme [the] Judgment was [given] ... for the murder[ing] of the said **Hugh [ap William]** ... And the said [Rees / Richard] ap [John], **William [Prydd / Prewd?]** ... [were] returned and sworn ... [and] indicted by [the grand jury] — **Morris ap William** [and others] ... for the said murder of the said [Hugh ap William] ... at a place called [the ___] ...

△ **Names provisional (verification-pass).** EARLIER HYPOTHESIS ("William Prydd/Prewd" = Prys/Price = Coke's "William ap Rice") is now **WEAKENED/SUPERSEDED**: the 2026-07-01 verification pass read 008 Art. 3's wronged man at magnification as the full three-element "**W[illia]m ap Res ap Willia[m]**" — which accounts for Coke's "William Price/ap Rice" directly (short form "William ap Rees," the kinsman "executed w[i]th yo[ur] said brother," Art. 2 verified). "William Prydd/Prewd" here is therefore most likely a **distinct co-indictee**, not Coke's Price. All indicted-list names still need professional TNA confirmation.

Row 7 (b7, src y ≈2641–3194) — the trial: bench, indictment, conviction "upon good and pregnant proof"

(left margin: a pencilled "Jones" — modern index note.)

... in the said Countie of Anglesey. And the [grand] Jury, upon **good and pregnant proof** (so this def[endant] thinketh) ... [as] in the said bill of complaint is declared. And this def[endant] further saith that ... before the said **William Brereton and Richard Barker esquires** ... at the great Sessions holden for the said Countie ... the said **Richard ap [John], William [Prydd / Prewd]** ... [with] **Morris ap William** [and others] ... [were by] the [grand] Jury indicted for the said murder of the said **[Hugh ap William]**, the said month of October last past, at the great Sessions ... [before Sebright[?]] Chief Justice of the said great Sessions ... [the prisoners] were then appointed to take their trial ... to pass upon the life and death of such prisoners ... of Anglesey, **without any [sure] blott, blemish or disability as by the said bill is supposed** ...
△ trial bench = **William Brereton + Richard Barker** (esquires). **VERIFICATION-PASS CORRECTIONS (2026-07-01, g3_b7 re-read)**: (1) the phrase before "Chief Justice" reads "... **also named, his Ma[jes]ties Chief Justice**" — my "[Sebright?]" was a misread of "his

maiesties"; the Chief Justice is **not personally named** here; (2) "without any **such** blott" (not "[sure] blott"); (3) the indicted list continues "**Morris ap Willia[m] and Ed[ward?]**..." — matching row 14's prisoner "Edward ap [__?]" ; (4) "the prisoners then **att [the] barre**." The indicted persons' names (William Prydd/Prewd, Richard ap John, Morris ap William, Edward ap [__?]) remain verification items for a professional transcription.

Rows 8–9 (b8–b9, src y ≈3074–4059) — jury sworn openly; Bulkeley found accessory; NO confederacy with Barker

... [jury of] good and substantial freeholders of the said Countie ... And before any of the said Jury [was sworn], their lawful [challenge / exception were heard] ... [he] did also return the Examined Jury for the said [Countie], [which] remained to be **most indifferent for his Ma[jes]tie** ... before the [Chief] Justice of the said great Sessions, then present and declared in open Court on his Ma[jes]tie['s] behalf ... of Anglesey **without any [sure] blott, blemish or disability as by the said bill is supposed** ... the prisoners then [appointed] to take their trial were **openly and publicly [sworn], as the said Justices allowed (as this def[endant] believeth)**. And this def[endant] further saith that ... the **Examined Jury lastly returned by this def[endant] did, upon their own evidence, [find] the said William Bulkeley accessory to the said murder before the [fact]** ... [and that] there was **no [true] plot, practice or confederacy between this def[endant] and the said Mr Justice [Barker]** ... touching the making or contriving of this [bill / matter] ... **△ the Lewis–Bulkeley faction war** is explicit: the Lewis–returned jury indicted **William Bulkeley** as accessory; the answer denies any Lewis–Barker confederacy (i.e., denies the very conspiracy Lloyd's bill alleged).

Row 10 (b10, src y ≈3939–4492) — no confederacy with Barker; Barker "upright & indifferent"; sheriff-succession

Legible fragments (g1→g4; exact line-order provisional — 4 quarter-columns × ~5 lines):

... [this def[endant]], amongst others, did [resort] to some special friends of his Lord[ship] in London, so that [he might make means] **that he should not be Sheriff for that time** rather ... [and that there was] **no plott, practice, confederacy or com[bination] between this def[endant] and the said Mr [Barker]** ... [nor with] any [of the prisoners] in the said bill of com[plaint] named, **for the m[ur]ther of the said [Hugh ap William]** ... in or upon the said [murther] ... And the said **Mr Justice Barker used and behaved himself uprightly, indifferently** (as this def[endant] thinketh) ... nor ... [gave] their friends ... [any] cause to mistake or misconstrue of the said ... And this def[endant] thinketh in his conscience that **the Compl[ainan]t being** ... [together] w[i]th **an elder brother of his** ... **△ stitch provisional at band 10; the sentence completes in band 11 and was RESOLVED there in the verification pass** (see Row 11: "the Com[mission]" was a misread of "the Compl[ainant]" — the clause is the Answer's attack on the complainant's own indictment/acquittal and his hidden backer, not a Commission clause).

Row 11 (b11, src y ≈4372–4925) — ★ REREAD & RESOLVED IN THE VERIFICATION PASS (2026-07-01): the complainant's own indictment; the WIFE-murder; the "private Adversary"

Verification-pass re-read (g2_b11 + g3_b11 + g4_b11 at full attention) **replaced the first-pass parse** ("the Com[mission] being ... necessary for the willful murder..." was WRONG — the word is "**the Compl[ainant]**", not "Commission"). The row now reads coherently:

... And this def[endant] thinketh in his conscience that **the Compl[ainant]** — being of [very] **sure meane estate as he is**, and one that [together] **w[i]th an elder brother of his hath ben indicted [for] ... [the murther]inge of the wieffe of the said Elder brother ... [and] upon their tryall the said Elder brother was thereof found guiltie** [and executed], and the said **Compl[ainant]** (as yt seemeth) [hardly escaped, and was found not guiltie] — **is countenanced and mainteyned therein by some private Adversary that will not himself [be seen] ... [and was thereby moved] to preferre this fraudulent and [most] devised libelous ... and infamous bill into this Ho[nourable] Courte against that reverend Justice, by meanes of [the said Adversary?] ... [the abuses which] were before followed and worked at ... are now (god be prayed) well reformed ... and the whole Countrey much bettered and amended.** And as touchinge the removinge to and keepinge of the said [prisoners] ... [de]livered up [to go] out of the said **Gaole and Castle of Anglesey** ...

★ **Verified readings:** "**wieffe of the said Elder brother**" is now CLEAR (w-i-e-f-f-e, g2_b11) — no longer bracketed. "**vpon their tryall the said Elder brother was thereof found guiltie**" (g3+g4_b11) and "**the said Compl[ainant]**" (g4_b11 line 2) are clear. "by some private Adversary that will not himself..." is clear.

★ **Cross-lock (recorded, still verification-pile as to names):** this passage = the Answer's account of a SECOND murder prosecution — the complainant's ELDER BROTHER (= 008 Art. 1's **John ap Evan Lloyd**) convicted & executed for murdering **his own wife** (= Art. 1's "murtheringe of his A[nn/m]is [Annes?]"), with the **complainant himself indicted for the same fact and acquitted** — matching 008 Art. 1's "And whether you were justlie or wrongfullie indicted for that fact yea or noe," 003R's "he himself was also unjustly and wrongfully indicted ... not in any sort privy or consenting," and HLS f.82v's "**Ignoramus found for the plt by speciall favour.**" The murder of **Hugh ap William** (rows 2–3, 6–7; Coke's report) is the OTHER prosecution (the drowned man of 1600; William Price convicted). Coke's print keeps only the Hugh-ap-William matter and one executed man.

Row 12 (b12, src y ≈4805–5358) — the castle-gaol custody dispute; defendant John Lewis again; Sir Richard Bulkeley controls the keys

Legible fragments (g1→g4; stitch provisional):

... and blemished, and the whole Countrey [much bettered] and amended. And [as] touching [the keeping of the gaol], **at the house of the said def[endant] John Lewis** — this def[endant] saith [that the Sheriff's gaol was kept at or within] some [part] of the **Castle of [Pen__? / Beaumaris?]** in the said [Countie]; [and this def[endant]] did **send to the said Sir Richard Bulkeley, desiring him** [touching] the keeping of the prisoners [that were] remaining or

should be during his [shrievalty] ... [and it was] returned [that] this [keeping] be [appointed] **by the said Sir Richard Bulkeley, and not the Gaoler of this def[endant]** ... forasmuch as **the Sheriff's gaol of the said Countie [of] Anglesey** [was within a Castle whereof] the said **Sir Richard Bulkeley** being, who **and yet is Constable** [of the said Castle] ... [Sir Richard desired] that he might have the **keys of the said Castle and Gaol to his hands**, for the more [surety] ... [so that the gaoler] should ... from time to time attend the said def[endant] or his deputy [with] the prisoners whensoever occasion [required] ...

★ **VERIFIED (2026-07-01 verification pass, tight zooms vcastle/vcastle2):** the castle name reads "**some p[ar]te of the Castell of Bewmares in the said Countie**" — **BEAUMARIS confirmed** (period spelling "Bewmares"); the grid-resolution "[Pen___?]" is retracted. Same zooms confirm "**at the house of the said def[endant] John Lewis**" (the defendant's name a 4th time), "this def[endant] did send ... **was enforced by the said messenger,**" and "**Bulkeley desiringe him that he might** [have the keys]."

Row 13 (b13, src y ≈5238–5790) — escapes from the castle gaol; Lewis rejects Bulkeley's custody: the prisoners were Bulkeley's "near friends ... and dependents"

Legible fragments (g1→g4; stitch provisional):

... [which keeping was] conferred to the said messenger, [as] **appointed by the said Sir Richard Bulkeley** ... [the keys] were given [to the keeper] of the said Castle ... [certain prisoners] **lately before made escape out of** [the said Gaol and Castle] ... [by default of] the keeping of the keys of the said Castle [by] Sir Richard Bulkeley ... [that the keeper appointed by Sir Richard Bul]keley, **and not the Gaoler of this def[endant]**, should from [the said] Castell [go] to the said prison where the said [prisoners lay] ... [and that the gaoler should] from time to time attend the said def[endant] or his deputy, or any his servants, whensoever occasion [required]. **W[hi]ch answe[r]e this def[endant] did not well like of, in respect that many prisoners** [then in the] said Gaole for the time being ... [within the said Cast]ell, **being near friends to and dependents upon the said [Lord?] of the said Castell** [= Sir Richard Bulkeley, the Constable] ... [and in respect that, by] the **wilful[ness] or negligence of the Gaoler of the said** [Castle, prisoners] remaining in gaole there ... **might the more easily escape out of the said Gaole or prison**, for want of [safe]tie and securitie therein — [he] being Sheriffe, and [answerable?] no less[e] ... beinge Sheriffe as afford said, **and, some what[?] f[a]rre[?] distant from the said Castell** *[[4C headline 1 — THIRD REVISION EVENT on 010, the interline now READ (caret + full superscript insertion): the Answer's added explanation for the prisoner transfer. RE-PARSE: the earlier fragment "[some had] detained[?]" from the said Castell WAS this interline read as baseline text; "detained" was "distant". Alternates preserved: "deteyn[e]d"; "some what / farre" both [?]; TNA]]* ... [su]ffered and procured a re[move] of the said p[ri]soners ... at [sundry / convenient] tymes; **Whereupon this def[endant], for his better safe[ty / discharge]** ... **△** "dependents" is an interlineation (caret) above the line — scribe's own insertion. The passage is the sheriff's justification for refusing the castle arrangement: the castle's Constable was **Sir Richard Bulkeley** — the man the Lewis-returned jury had found **accessory to the murder** (row 9) — and the prisoners inside were **his friends and dependents**, an escape/rescue risk. The custody fight is the faction war in miniature.

Row 14 (b14, src y ≈5671–6223) — prisoners removed to John Lewis's OWN HOUSE; night-and-day watch at his own charge; next charge answered: offices "for money or other valuable consideration"

Legible fragments (g1→g4; stitch provisional):

Whereupon this def[endant], for his better safe[ty] and dischardge [undertook] the [making / mending?] of walles for keepinge of the Gaole ... [as other Sheriffes have usually?] done upon the like occasions ... **the removinge of the said prisoners to his owne house: by vertue of w[hi]ch Com[m]ission the said def[endant] removed the said Edward ap [_?] and other** [prisoners] ... **to his — the said def[endant] John Lewis['s] — house, wherein** [the said] **prisoners remayned untill they were returned** [and turned] **over to the newe Sheriffe** of that [Countie], as lawfullie he might, in such convenient tyme and as by the lawes [and] statutes of this Realme [is] in such cases required ... **(to his greate charge and expences, beinge dryven to finde & mainteyne men to watch them night and day, duringe the space of [blank — gap left in the MS] ...)** where he might the better intend [their safe keeping] ... to looke unto them; **[no/as] other Sheriffe [hath/shall?] [vs?]uall[ie] formerlie done vpon the like occasions** *[[4C △ NEW FLAG (sense-flip candidate, TNA): if "no", Lewis claims he did what NO other sheriff had formerly done — vs the grid's "[as other Sheriffes have usually?] done"; strokes support "no other Sheriffe" but the verb is stain-crossed]]* ... [prisoners] beinge ma[n]y [and?] ... establish[e]d in the [gaole?] ... **And as touchinge the not makinge or appointinge & [swea?/ser?]vinge[?] of deputi[es]** *[[4C: &-token stain-crossed; "swearinge"/"serving" both kept; TNA]]* ... [the dis]charge of offices belonginge to the said Sheriffe wick[e] *[[4C headline 2 — "SHERIFFEWICK" RECOVERED: the earlier "writt for money or other [reward?]" flag reads "...[the dis]charge of offices belonginge to the said Sheriffewick[e], for money or other valuable considerac[i]on" — "writt" was the tail of Sheriffwick (the shrievalty); "[reward?]" RETRACTED]]* ... **for money or other valuable considerac[i]on** ... this def[endant] saith ... [the] Counsell named [in the said bill] ... △
 Notables: (1) **"John Lewis house"** — the defendant's name legible a third time, in the custody-transfer clause; (2) the scribe left a **blank gap** for the duration of the night-and-day watch (never filled in); (3) prisoner name **"Edward ap [_?]"** — verification-pass item; (4) the Answer here pivots to the bill's next charge: **selling/farming the sheriff's under-offices for money** — Lewis's answer to it runs into rows 15–16.

Row 15 (b15, src y ≈6104–6657) — the office-fees answer: bailiffs of the hundreds, keeping of courts, "some small [fee] ... which was lawful", customary and "not otherwise"

Legible fragments (g1→g4; stitch provisional; this band is heavily stained/faded mid-leaf):

... [the sell?]inge of **offices belonginge to the said Sheriffe ... for money or other valuable consideration** ... [the persons] alleged in the said bill of com[plaint], **named to be his deputies** ... [his] deputie Sheriffe of the said [Countie] ... And this def[endant] **further saith that the Sheriffe, or his deputie (for the tyme beinge)**, of the said [Countie] ... did appointe the said [bayliffs — interlined *[[4C: seen directly eyes-on ✓]]*] [of] **the hundred[s]** ... [and] he [at his?] pleasure appointed the **place & place[s]** *[[4C ★ FIRM ×2 (second instance with clear terminal-s);*

"[person & persons?]" RETRACTED for ... **the doinge of all [manner] of Courts ... the keepinge of Courts w[i]thin the said [hundreds?] ... [which] was sometymes avaiable and beneficiall to the said Sheriff[e/s]** ¶4C ★: "[inhabitants/suitors?]" RETRACTED in favor of Sheriffe — the appointments were profitable to the SHERIFF, sharpening the confession-and-avoidance ¶ ... and in regard that the said [wages / profits?] ... [for] w[hi]ch **he did receave & take some smalle rewarde** ¶4C: "rewarde" now the lead for the "[fee/sum]" bracket (two sightings) ¶ ... [of the said [Griffith?] — name uncertain ¶4C X SCAN-LIMITED: "[G/Th?][?ili?][d?][th did receave..." — EITHER a Welsh personal name OR a phrase ("the like duties"?); eR noise-dominated in the stain zone; "[Griffith?]" stays an UNCONFIRMED lead (☐ ledger A12); formal TNA item ¶] ... **w[hi]ch was lawfull for him so to do, and that ... as [other] Sheriffs have vsed vsuall[ie] [to receave], and not otherwise** ¶4C ✓ close verbatim ¶ ... All w[hi]ch matters [he is ready to aver?] ... ¶4C △ NEW CLAUSE CANDIDATE (faded): "that ev[er]y [Sheriffe/officer?] before he shall [?]..." — possibly an oath-of-office clause in the fees answer; TNA ¶ △

Notables: (1) this is a **confession-and-avoidance on the fees charge** — small customary sums for bailiwick/court-keeping appointments, admitted and defended as lawful custom; (2) "bayliffs" is an interlineation; (3) the payer's name ("[Griffith?]") and the g3 "place & places / person & persons" doublet are verification-pass items; (4) bottom edge of g4_b15 catches the **top of the counsel signature** — "[B/L]oyd" — final reading belongs to row 16 + the sig zoom.

Row 16 (b16, src y ≈6537–7029) — the PRAYER + the foot: costs formula, "6d" fee note, counsel signature "Boyd [/ Boys?]"

Legible fragments (g1→g4; membrane foot, lower third blank parchment; bottom-right corner clipped diagonally):

... **w[hi]ch was lawfull for him so to do** ... All w[hi]ch matters [this def[endant] is ready to aver and prove as this Ho[nourable] Court shall award?] ... [prayeth to be] **d[i]smised [from hence / out of this Court] w[i]th his reasonable [costs] ... [his] costs and charges in that behalfe most wrongfully [sustained] ...**

Foot subscriptions: (1) ¶4C ★★ headline 3 — THE FOOT SUBSCRIPTION MYSTERY RESOLVED: the "large flourished subscription [S_?]zand[?] / [Ll_?]d[?]" is the engrossed PRAYER, not a name/jurat — it reads "**dismissed by[?] th[e/is] ho[nora]ble[?] Co[ur]te[?] w[i]th...**" written large at line start, sloping up into "...reasonable costes and charges in that behalfe most wrongfullie **susteyned**" (prayer tail now firm; "[sustained]" bracket resolved). "[S_?]zand[?]" was a mid-word misparse of "[di]smised" (double long-s taken for z). Foot layout fully accounted for: engrossed prayer → right foot "& 6d" note → counsel signature → paraph → corner clip ¶; (2) right foot: **"6d"** fee note ¶4C NEW: the faded line just above the signature ends "...[ack?]nowled[?] ... & 6d" — candidate jurat-class acknowledgment note + the fee, not merely a bare "6d"; TNA ¶; (3) below it the flourished **counsel signature "Boyd"** ¶4C: initial-B FIRM at 2×; terminal still flourish-crossed — "Boys" stays possible; ledger A9 ¶ — with a paraph beneath. Counsel-signature position for a Star Chamber Answer.

¶PHASE 4C FOLD-IN, 2026-07-08 (user-approved): rows 13–16 spot pass + seam strips + standing-[?] renders complete (_WORKING_P4C_AUDIT.md). **VERDICT: the grid/Phase-B text SURVIVES; NO lost text found anywhere in the spot zone.** Net: revision event #3 read (the distant-from-the-castle interline); Sheriffewick; place-&-places; avaiable-to-the-Sheriffe; susteyned; the engrossed-prayer resolution; seam-

A/B tokens all anchor verbatim (incl. the John-Lewis-house clause 3rd sighting, the returned-to-the-newe-Sheriffe clause, the night-and-day-watch BLANK gap seen directly). Remaining scan-limited → TNA: the fee-payer name; the "[no/as] other Sheriffe" verb; the interline "some what / f[a]rre" tokens; the Boyd terminal; the "[ack?]nowled[?] & 6d" note; the 010 head jotting (ink-screen item).

PRECISION RE-VERIFICATION (third pass, Fable 5) — rows 1–12, 2026-07-02

Recut cells `crop_p10g[1-4]_b[1-16].jpg` (q80/2200px, session scratchpad). Notes below SUPPLEMENT the grid-pass rows above (which are left intact for provenance); where a reading below conflicts with a grid-pass reading, the PRECISION reading governs.

Row 1 (b1) — caption + opening formula

- **Superscript top note (g1, above caption zone):** reads "[W]illm W[e/i]ll[?]" — a two-word name-like jotting (filing/index note?). Function unknown; professional item. (Earlier logged as "[versus] [William Well?]").)
- **Caption (g2–g3):** "[The Aun]swere of Joh[n] Le[wis?] ... **one of the Defendants** ... [to the bill of compl[ain]t of? ... Rees ap E]van Loyd th[e/at?] **Complaynant**" — consistent with the resolved caption (capA/B/C zooms); forename zone still faint at band resolution.
- **Body opening sentence (L1–L2, stitched g1→g4 with overlap duplications confirmed):** "The said def[endan]t saieth that the said bill of compl[ain]t [exhibited/devised?] against this def[endan]t [and others?] ... is for the most [p[ar]te?] [...] and in the ch[iefest?] and [...] and **materiall matters and things therein conteyn[e]d very untrue and scandalous**, and as this def[endan]t is by his ^[said?] **learned Councell enformed, [unc]erterayne and insuffi[ci]ent in the lawes to be a[u]nswered unto by this def[endan]t for sundrie imp[er]fec[i]ons** [therein appearinge?] ..."
- ★ CORRECTIONS vs grid pass: "**scandalous**" (grid-pass "fraudulent" RETRACTED — the word is long-s + candalous, clear in g1_b1/b2 overlap); "**matters and things**" (not "charge[s]"); "for sundrie **imp[er]fec[i]ons**" (not "[causes]"; clear twice, g4_b1/b2 overlap).

Row 2 (b2) — ★★ THE CONTRIVANCE SENTENCE: Bulkeley direction + JURY-FEAR purpose clause

Physical lines L2–L7 stitch cleanly across g1→g4 (overlap words duplicate at column seams, confirming alignment). The sentence after the insufficiency formula:

"...devised, framed and contrived by the Compl[ainan]t **by the [instigac[i]on/p[er]suasion?]** and **direcc[i]on of the said W[illia]m Buckeley** in the said bill of compl[ain]t named [and others?] **(as this def[endan]t verelie beleveth and is p[er]swaded in his Conscience)**, of purpose not onlie to [vexe?], **[gre]ve and trouble this def[endan]t w[i]th longe and tedious suits in lawe, w[i]thout anie matter or good grounde**, of malice (as yt seemith); **butt alsoe to stryke a feare into the h[a]rts of all such freeholders of the said Countie of Anglesey** [as] att the next greate Sessions to be holden for the said [Countie] shalbe **retorned or impannelled for or upon the try[a]lls of the said W[illia]m Bullkeley (whoe standeth**

indicted att the said greate Sessions as [accessarie?/is witnessed?] [for/unto?] the willfull murtheringe of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [named?] in the said bill of compl[ain]t) and of other the frends of the said W[illia]m Bulkeley whose stand[s] [likewise?] indicted [for the said murther?] ... [and had then alsoe to [?] and open[?] ...] wherof this def[endan]t humblie praieth this Ho: Courte to have due considerac[i]on and to ..."

- ★★ MAJOR CORRECTION vs grid pass: the "institutional-stakes clause" ("to strike & bring into [danger that] all [the officers of the] Chamber of England shall be [questioned] or imprisoned") is **RETRACTED** — the clause is a **JURY-INTIMIDATION theory**: "**to stryke a feare into the harts of all such freeholders** ... retorned or impannelled for or upon the try[a]lls of ... Bulkeley ... and of other the frends of...". "questioned or imprisoned" was a misread of "**retorned or impannelled**"; "Chamber of England" a misparse of "**Countie of Anglesey**"; "officers" of "**freeholders**".
- ★★ The Answer's theory of the bill: **Lloyd's Star Chamber bill = an instrument to terrify the jurors empanelled for the UPCOMING trial of William Bulkeley (indicted accessory) and his indicted friends.** The word "**feare**" is in the manuscript — the defense-side mirror of the deterrence rationale Coke prints in the report. [SURFACE-ONLY: do not fold into THE_TWO_LOCKS.md until professional verification + user adjudication.]
- Also verified: "**whose standeth indicted**" (grid-pass "whose slanders" RETRACTED); the parenthetical marks around the Bulkeley-indicted clause and around "(as yt seemith)" / "(as this deft verelie beleveth...)" are scribal.
- Uncertain (ledger items): the instigation-word before "and direcc[i]on"; "[vexe?]; g4-L5 tail "as [?]ness[?]" ("as accessarie"? "as is witnessed"?); "Hughe ap W[illia]m [named?/Jonis?]" — the glyph after W[illia]m superficially reads "Jonis" (victim styled "Hugh ap William Jones"?) but "named" fits the formula; the L7 clause "and h[a]d then alsoe to [?] and open[?] th[?]".
- Left margin (g1_b2): archival pencil "**63/38**".

Row 3 (b3) — prayer not to answer · SAVING CLAUSE · GENERAL TRAVERSE (restructured)

The grid-pass row-3 parse ("exception to the said unlawful and manifest plot...") conflated two distinct clauses. Corrected structure:

1. **Prayer**: "...wherof this def[endan]t humblie praieth this Ho: Courte to have due considerac[i]on And [that] the said def[endan]t sh[o]uld[e] [not?] be **ordered or compelled to make anie aunswere to the said fr[audulent?/ivolous?] [bill]...**" (the "not" is assumed from formula — not yet seen; ledger item. The word "fraudulent" likely lives HERE, not in the opening characterization.)
2. **Saving clause**: "...[with] excepc[i]on to the incertaintie[s], insufficiencie and other the imp[er]fec[i]ons [and] defect[e]s thereof, to the said def[endan]t nowe and att all tymes hereafter saved and allowed." (Grid-pass "benefit and advantage of the said bill" → reads "the benefitt and advauntage of the[?] excepc[i]ons"-type formula.)
3. **General traverse**: "The said def[endan]t for [aun]swere to soe much of the said bill as doth anie waye concerne him saithe **That he is not guyltie of the said unlawfull and manifest plotte, practizes, confederacies, combinac[i]ons and misdemeano[u]rs** in the said bill of com[plaint] menc[i]oned or [expressed?], **nor of anie** [the?] [assaults/exactions?], unlawfull [?], [extor]c[i]on[?], **sellinge of offices and other the offences ... as in and by the said bill of compl[ain]t is supposed.**"

- ★ The four-noun formula "plotte, practizes, confederacies, combinac[i]ons" is CLEAR (g4_b3); "selling of offices" appears in the traverse's offence-list (previewing the rows-14–15 fees answer).
- Also: "be hence dismissed w[i]th his reasonable [g2:] chardges therein susteyned. **And yet notw[i]thstandinge...**" ✓ (grid ✓); the g1 offence-list line ("assaults[?] unlawfull [?]nd[?]s [corr?]upc[i]on[?]") is a ledger item.
- Left margin (g1_b4 catches it): the purple **PRO oval stamp**.

Row 4 (b4) — ★ DATED APPOINTMENT SENTENCE (new date: February 1605[/6])

Full stitch (L-wraps confirmed by overlap duplications):

"...is supposed. **Howebeit this def[endan]t for the further satisfacc[i]on of this Ho: Courte** [and for?] the declarac[i]on and manifestac[i]on of the truethe of [the matters?] of the said bill [of] compl[ain]t as doth concerne him, this def[endan]t saithe that **aboute the moneth of ffebruar[ie] Anno D[omi]ni 1605 this def[endan]t John Lewis was by vertue of his Ma[jes]ties Com[m]ission under the greate Seale of England nomi[n]ated and appointed [to] be Sheriffe of the said Countie of Anglesey for the yere then next followinge or duringe his Ma[jes]ties pleasure.** And in or aboute the moneth of **August last past** in the said bill of compl[ain]t menc[i]oned, the said def[endan]t **John Lewis beinge then Highe Sheriffe of the said Countie of Anglesey** as [afore]said did [...jury return, row 5]"

- ★ NEW vs grid pass: the appointment date "**ffebruar[ie] Anno D[omi]ni 1605**" (= Feb 1605/6 if Lady-Day reckoning) fills the grid-pass blank "in or about the month [of ____]"; "**nomi[n]ated and appointed**"; "**for the yere then next followinge or duringe his Ma[jes]ties pleasure**"; "for the further satisfacc[i]on of this Ho: Courte."
- ★ Chronology lock: Feb 1605/6 appointment → Aug 1606 ("August last past") jury return → Oct 1606 great Sessions (rows 6–7 "October last past") → Answer c. winter 1606/7 → Coke's report Trin. 5 Jac. (1607). Internally coherent.
- "John Lewis" legible x2 in g2_b4 ✓ (grid ✓); "in such sorte man[ner] and fforme" (grid "strict sort" → "**such** sorte").

Row 5 (b5) — the jury return: IMPARTIALITY FORMULA + jury quality (complete stitch)

"...the said def[endan]t John Lewis beinge then Highe Sheriffe of the said Countie of Anglesey as [afore]said did [then?], **accordinge to his place and office, w[i]thout anie p[ar]cialitie, favo[u]r, affecc[i]on, hatred or malice towards anie p[er]son or p[er]sons therein [named?],** [as in like cases hath ben?] used, **retorne[d] the said Graunde Jur[ie] of such sufficient p[er]sons, as well Esquiers as gent[lemen] and other good and substantiall freeholders of the said Countie of Anglesey, as was requisite for his Ma[jes]ties ser[vice]** ... [nor could anie?] **(to this def[endan]ts knowledge)** take anie **lawfull excepc[i]ons to anie of them** ... [the p[er]sons?] [?]onded to be retorned upon the said [Graunde?] Jur[ie] by this def[endan]t as Sheriffe of the said [Countie] ... **whereof he referreth himself[e] to the said**

retorne beinge of Record [remayninge?] ... but for the more certentie[?] [as this def[endan]t taketh yt?] ..."

- ★ NEW vs grid pass: the impartiality formula (parcialitie/favour/affeccion/hatred/malice — complete); "**as well Esquiers as gent[lemen]**" (the jury's rank); "accordinge to his place and office"; "as was requisite for his Ma[jes]ties ser[vice]"; "he referreth himself[e] to the said retorne" (record-reference formula); "**Graunde** Jur[ie]" now reads directly (g4_b5) where the grid pass hedged "[Examined/Grand]".
- "John Lewis" again at g2_b5 L1 (overlap).

Row 6 (b6) — ★ the indictment clause: STRUCK NAME ZONE + the five indictees + the murder PLACE

"...And [the persons?] upon the said Jury were [noted/retorned?] ... **And doth not knowe that the[y] were confederated together, or otherwise bound them selu[e]s each to other to hould[e] together in [a]ll acc[i]ons[?] ...**, to this def[endan]ts knowledge[.] In or aboute [October?] ... **aboute wh[at] tyme a bill of Inditem[en]t was p[re]ferred agaynste the said Richard ap John, W[illia]m Prend[?], Richard ap Richard[?], Moris ap W[illia]m and Edward ap John** — with a scribal STRIKE-THROUGH zone on the first-written line (g1-g2 seam; struck strokes read like "~~W[illia]m ap [?]ellew/Kellew~~" with "[Ri/Ed]ward[?] ap John" adjacent) — **for the murtheringe of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [P/J]end[?] [named?] in the said bill of compl[ain]t, at a place called the Rodwha[?] [Rodwfa[?]] ...**, [and they] **were then by the said graunde [Jury] indicted for the said murther** of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [?]..."

- ★ CORRECTIONS vs grid pass: "aboute what tyme **a bill of Inditem[en]t was p[re]ferred**" (grid "Judgment was [given]" RETRACTED); the murder place "**the Rodwha[?]**" now has strokes (grid blank "[the ____]"); the confederacy-denial completes ("bound them selu[e]s each to other to hould together in all acc[i]ons" — the bill's conspiracy language quoted-and-denied).
- ★ INDICTEE LIST (all still professional-verification names): **Richard ap John** (clear at g3_b6 L4 — grid's "[Rees/Richard]" resolves toward Richard), **W[illia]m Prend[?]** (the standing Prydd/Prewd item), **Richard ap Richard[?]** (new candidate), **Moris ap W[illia]m** ✓, **Edward ap John** (clear at g4_b6 L6 — supplies row 14's "Edward ap [__?]" patronymic!).
- ★ RECURRING TOKEN after the victim's name (3× now: g2_b2 L6, g3_b6 L5, g4_b6 L7): "Hughe ap W[illia]m **[P/J]end[?]/[named?]**" — either the formula word "named" or a 4th name element ("Prend"/"Jones"/"Jenkin"?). If a surname, the victim shares it with indictee W[illia]m Prend[?]. PROFESSIONAL ITEM (high value).
- ★ STRUCK ZONE (g1_b6 L5 → g2_b6 L5): first-draft indictee text struck through before the clean list — TNA should recover the deleted reading.

Row 7 (b7) — the trial sentence (bench + juries), full stitch

"And this def[endan]t further saith, that att or aboute **the said moneth of October last past** att the gre[ate Sessions] ... the said **Richard ap John, W[illia]m Prend[?], [Richard ap Richard?], Moris ap W[illia]m and Edward ap John were then by the said graunde Jury indicted for the said murther of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [P/J]end[?]** as in the [said bill?] ... att the greate Sessions holden for the said Countie of Anglesey before the said **W[illia]m Brereton and Richard Barker esquiers, in the said bill of compl[ain]t alsoe named, his ma[jes]t[ie]s Chief Justic[e?] of the said greate Sessions[.]** This def[endan]t ... **did retorne a Jury to passe upon the lief and death of such prisoners as were then appointed to take their tryalls ... of good and substantiall gent[lemen] and freeholders of the said Countie of Anglesey w[i]thout anie such blott blemishe or disabilit[ie] as by the said bill is supposed ...** And before anie of the said Jury [was] sworne, the prisoners then **att barre ... [the prisoners appointed to] take their tryalls were openlie and publicklie [sworne/called?]...**"

- ✓ CONFIRMS verification-pass corrections: "alsoe named his ma[jes]t[ie]s Chief Justice" (no personal name — "[Sebright?]" retraction stands); "anie **such** blott"; "att barre"; and the conviction/indictment "**upon good and pregnant proof[e]s**" (g1_b7, plural).
- ★ NEW PARSE QUESTION (professional): "...Brereton and Richard Barker **esquiers**, in the said bill of compl[ain]t alsoe named, his ma[jes]t[ie]s **Chief Justic[e/es?]** of the said greate Sessions" — singular/plural of "Justice" decides whether the phrase (a) names a third, unnamed person (grid/verification-pass assumption), (b) styles the PAIR as the court, or (c) attaches to one of them. Cross-check 009 Art. 13's "**Leighton**" (a possible third bench name). High-value TNA item.
- ★ The b2 victim-token recurs at g4_b7 L2 ("Hughe ap W[illia]m [P/J]end as in the...") — 4th sighting.
- Chronology: indictment AND trial at the October 1606 great Sessions; "att or aboute the said moneth of October last past."
- Margin (g1_b7): pencilled "**Jones**" (modern archival note) ✓ grid.

Row 8 (b8) — the trial-jury phase: challenges WARNED, body-of-county return, Bulkeley accessory

"...[the prisoners appointed to] take their tryalls **were openlie and publicklie [sworne/called?]** ... And before anie of **the said Jury upon lief & death** [was sworne?] ... **their lawfull challenge were then by the said Justices allowed (as this def[endan]t beleveth)** ... [the prisoners (then att barre...)] **warned to looke to theire Challenge**, And ... [he] did alsoe **retorne the [Examined?] Jury for the body of the said Countie of such esquiers, gent[lemen] and other substantiall freeholders ... [adjudged?] to be most indifferent for his ma[jes]t[ie]s [service?]** ... And this def[endan]t alsoe saith that he beinge [Highe Shiriffe] ... att the said greate **Sessions holden in the said moneth of October** [last past] ... **the said Examined Jury lastlie retorned by this def[endan]t did upon there evidence ... [find] the said W[illia]m Bulkeley ... [acc]essarie[?] to the said murther**

before the [fact?] ... [as was?] declared in open Courte on his ma[jes]t[ie]s behalfe agaynst the said W[illia]m Bulkeley ..."

- ★ NEW vs grid pass: the prisoners were affirmatively "**warned to looke to their Challenge**" (caret interlineation "to"); the petty jury styled "**the said Jury upon lief & death**"; the return "**for the body of the said Countie**" (de corpore comitatus formula); the open-court declaration's target "**agaynst the said W[illia]m Bulkeley**"; "as this def[endan]t remembred[/eth?]" (memory-hedge, g1_b8 L5).
- ✓ VERIFIED verbatim: "the said **Examined Jury** lastlie retorned by this def[endan]t" — so "**Graunde Jury**" (b5–b6, indictment) and "**Examined Jury**" (b8, trial) are BOTH real, distinct MS terms; the grid-pass Grand-vs-Examined hedges resolve as two different juries, one clause each. Bulkeley "accessarie ... before the [fact]" ✓; "(as this def[endan]t beleveth)" parens scribal ✓.
- ★ "the said **Justices** allowed" — plural in this clause (g3_b8 L3) and possibly "Chief Justice[s?]" at g2_b8 L6: strengthens the row-7 parse question (Brereton + Barker = the Justices of the great Sessions).
- Physical: small HOLE in parchment at g1_b8 mid-left.

Row 9 (b9) — ★★ the central denial, complete: NO PLOT WITH JUSTICE BARKER touching the IMPANELLING; marginal cross at the line

"...[found the said W[illia]m Bulkeley acc]essa[rie] to the said murther **before the fact committed ... All wh[i]ch said [seve]rall retornes soe made by this def[endan]t were made w[i]thoute anie p[ar]cialitie, favo[u]r, [or] malice ... or respect of anie p[er]son or p[er]sons ... whatsoev[er] therein used or [cherished?]. And this def[endan]t further saithe that there was noe suche plott, practizes or confederacies betwene the said def[endan]t and the said M[r] Justice Bar[ker] [att the said greate Sessions?] nor anie other tyme or w[i]th anie other, for or touchinge the makinge & [im]pannellinge of the [said Juries/retornes?] ... And ... he this def[endan]t did [make?] some meanes that he should not be Sheriffe for that tyme[;] Neither was there [anie?] [?]tion of anie of the said p[er]sons in the [said bill?] ... [amongest others he] did write his l[ett]res [un]to some spetiall frends of his [heere?] in London ... for the yere then next followinge or otherwise ..."**

- ★★ CORRECTION vs grid pass: the denied confederacy's SUBJECT is "**the makinge & [im]pannellinge**" (of the juries/returns) — NOT "the making or contriving of this [bill/matter]". The bill alleged Lewis+Barker rigged the jury composition; the Answer denies exactly that.
- ★★ MARGINAL MARK: a small **cross/+ in the left margin at the Barker-denial line** (g1_b9 L5, "...the said def[endan]t and the said M[r] Justice Bar[ker]") — an early reader/clerk flagged the case-critical line. PROFESSIONAL ITEM (identify the hand/purpose).
- ★ CORRECTION: the sheriff-avoidance was by CORRESPONDENCE — "did **write his l[ett]res**" (grid "[resort]" retracted); its object "that he should not be Sheriffe **for that tyme**" ✓, "for the yere then next followinge or otherwise" (he was avoiding the NEXT year's appointment too).
- ★ The all-returns impartiality summary ("All wh[i]ch said severall retornes...") is NEW — the Answer twice applies the impartiality formula (per-return at row 5, globally here).

- Ledger items: g3_b9 L3 "[?]m[?] D[oo]med[?] by this def[endan]t sundrilie and [un]lawfull[ie?]" (function unclear — bill-language recital?); g4_b9 L6 "[nor anie?] under standinge that he was in the retorne [?]" (possible Barker-knowledge denial); "or [che]r[i]shed[?]" tail.

Row 10 (b10) — ★★ "CALLINGE IN QUESTION" + the £20 interlineation + the full Barker praise

"...he this def[endan]t did [make?] some meanes **that he should not be Sher[iffe]** [for that tyme] ... **Neither was there anie plott practize confederacie or combynac[i]on betwene this def[endan]t and the said M[r] Bar[ker] or anie other touchinge the callinge in question of anie of the said p[er]sons in the said bill of compl[ain]t named for the murther of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [Prydde?] ... [/]in or upon the said Inditem[en]ts[.]** And the said def[endan]t further saidth that in all the said severall p[ro]ceedinge[s] in his place and wh[at?] ^{th[er]e} [was a]l[l]edged and aunswere[?] ... **the said Justice Barker used and behaved him[self] soe uprightlie, indifferentlie and iustlie ... [that none] — noe not the offenders them selu[e]s and suche [othe]r of their frends as earnestlie labo[u]red [?]ed to save their l[i]v[e]s — could have noe [just?] cause to mislike or thinke otherwise of his said [proceedinge[s]]** (this def[endan]t thinketh) ... And this def[endan]t thinketh in his conscience that **the Compl[ain]t beinge of s[u]re meane estate as he is** not worthe xx li in all the worlde to this def[endan]ts kn[o]wledg[e] **and one that [together?/ioyntlie?] w[i]th an elder brother of his hath ben indicted ..."**

- ★★ "touchinge the callinge in question of anie of the said p[er]sons ... in or upon the said Inditem[en]ts" — the denial covers instigating the PROSECUTION itself, and the manuscript's own phrase is "callinge in question" — the same term of art Coke's printed report elevates into the immunity rationale ("judges ... shall not be drawn in question"). Record-internal vocabulary lock. [SURFACE-ONLY for THE_TWO_LOCKS — professional verification + user adjudication first.]
- ★★ INTERLINEATION (g3_b10 L5.5 → g4 seam): "not worthe xx li in all the worlde to this def[endan]ts kn[o]wledg[e]" — the complainant's worth capped at **£20** (glyph "xx li"; "xl"=£40 the alternate candidate — professional). Scribally inserted above "sure meane estate as he is" — the Answer QUANTIFIES Lloyd's poverty, sharpening the maintenance theory ("countenanced and mainteyned ... by some private Adversary," row 11).
- ★ The Barker praise upgraded: THREE adverbs ("**soe uprightlie, indifferentlie and iustlie**"), and the no-complaint universe extends to "the offenders them selu[e]s and suche [othe]r of their frends as earnestlie labo[u]red ... to save their l[i]v[e]s" — even the convicts' own advocates "[had] noe cause to **mislike or thinke otherwise** of his said [proceedings]."
- ✓ VERIFIED verbatim vs grid/verification pass: second denial formula ("plott practize confederacie or combynac[i]on"); "for the murther of the said Hughe ap W[illia]m [—]" (victim token 5th sighting, best candidate now "**P[ry]dd[e]**" — reconciles with indictee "W[illia]m Prend/Prydd"); "elder brother of his ha[th] ben indicted"; "did write his l[ett]res" (letters confirmed).
- Ledger: "frends of his herd[?]/heere[?] in London"; "of suche[?]/sure[?] meane estate" (first token); the L4 interline "th[er]e"; the L7 fragment "[?] some quarrell [?] the said Compl[?]" (b11 covers).

Row 11 (b11) — ★★ THIRD READ of the private-Adversary passage: all anchors verbatim + new refinements

Triple-verified (grid → verification zooms → precision cells). The passage now reads:

"And this def[endan]t thinketh in his conscience that the Compl[ainan]t beinge of s[u]re meane estate as he is ^{not worthe xx li...} and one that **(together w[i]th an elder brother of his hath ben indicted [as acc]essary[?] for the wilfull murtheringe of the [wieffe] ... [and] upon their tryall the said Elder brother was thereof found guiltie and the said Compl[ainan]t ... hardly escaped and was found not guiltie)** is countenaunced and mainteyned therein by some private Adversary that will not him self (as yt seemeth) be [k]nowne/[seene?] in this [busines?] ... wh[i]ch hathe caused the said Compl[ainan]t (as [yt seemeth?]) to p[re]ferre this scandalous and [?] and infamous bill into this Ho: Courte agaynst that reverend Justice, by meanes of [?] ... [the] [e?]villes[?], enormities and oppressions [that] were before followed and worked at are nowe (god be prayesd) well reformed [?ab/b?]l[?]ished and the whole Countrey much bettered and amended. And as touchinge the removinge ^{to} and keepinge of the said [prisoners] ... [de]livered [up?] to th[e]m out of the said Gaole [and] Castle of Anglesey and usually [?] ..."

- ★★ NOW DIRECT (was supplied-bracket in the verification pass): "**hardly escaped and was found not guiltie**" (g1_b11 L3); the parenthetical CLOSES before "**is countenaunced and mainteyned therein by**" (g2_b11 L3 — close-paren visible).
- ★★ NEW: the Adversary clause extends "**that will not him self (as yt seemeth) be [k]nowne/[seene] in this [busines?]**"; the bill-preferment causation "**wh[i]ch hathe caused the said Compl[ainan]t**"; the bill styled "**scandalous ... and infamous**" at preferment (echoing the opening "very untrue and scandalous").
- ★★ NEW — the reform passage is BARKER-SPECIFIC: "**whose cominge into this Countrey**" (g1_b11 L5) — the Answer credits Justice Barker's circuit arrival with reforming Anglesey's "[e?]villes[?], **enormities and oppressions.**" (Grid read the reform generically.)
- ★ NEW CANDIDATE: the complainant indicted "[as acc]essary[?] for the wilfull murtheringe" of the wife — paralleling Bulkeley's accessory posture in the Hugh-murder. Professional item.
- Ledger: "[?] that forth[with?] [?] the Sheriff gaole of the [said Countie]" (g3_b11 L7, row-12 seam); "[?ab/b?]l[?]ished" (the verb pairing with "well reformed"); "by meanes of [?]" tail still unread.

Row 12 (b12) — ★★ the keys narrative REVERSED: Lewis asked, Bulkeley refused

"...And as touchinge the removinge ^{to} and keepinge of the said [prisoners] ... **att the house of the said def[endan]t John Lewis[:]** This def[endan]t saith that **forasmuche ^{as} the Sheriff gaole of the said [Countie] [was/resteth?] w[i]th[i]n [the said] Castle [of ^{see castle-name conflict below} S[i]r Richard Bulkeley Knight** **whoe [was?] and yet is Constable [thereof] ..., this def[endan]t did send to the said S[i]r Richard Bulkeley desiringe him that he [= this def[endan]t] might have the keys of the said Castell and Gaole to his hands, for the more [suretie?] [and] safe keepinge of the p[ri]soners that were [then?] remayninge or should**

be duringe his Shir[ie]fwike ... and was enformed by the said messenger that the said S[i]r Richard Bulkeley ... (but) retorne[d] this aunswere ... that the said def[endan]t should not have the key of the Castell, but the Gaoler [ap]pointed by the said S[i]r Richard Bulkeley and not the Gaoler of this def[endan]t should from tyme to tyme attend the said def[endan]t or his deputie or anie his servaunts whensoev[er] occasion [required] ..."

- ★★ PARSE CORRECTION vs grid pass: the keys request was **LEWIS's** ("desiringe him that he might have the keys ... **to his hands** for the more [suretie]"), and **Bulkeley REFUSED** ("the said def[endan]t **should not have the key of the Castell**" — g3_b12 L6 + g4_b12 L6, two independent readings). Grid's "[Sir Richard desired] that he might have the keys ... for the more [surety]" is RETRACTED. Row 13's "W[hi]ch answere this def[endan]t did not well like of" = Bulkeley's refusal-answer.
- ★ NEW: "**S[i]r Richard Bulkeley Knight**" (title); "**his Shir[ie]fwike**" (the term "sheriffwick" — grid's supplied "[shrievalty]"); "forasmuche ^{as}" (caret interline); "(but) retorne[d] this aunswere"; "safe keepinge."
- ✓ CASTLE-NAME CONFLICT RESOLVED (Pass-4 pilot 2026-07-07, tile p4castle @2× native + eB): "**Bewmar[e]s**" — the initial matches the in-frame secretary-B of "Bulkeley" (L5 below) and differs from the p of "p[ar]te" (same line); the "Pen—" readings of both band passes were the sub-native-resolution illusion (this cell was read at 0.77× in the grid layers). Terminal letters still carry a loop two passes took for "d" — best parse: the e+long-s ligature's back-loop ("Bewmares" with flourish); noted for the routine TNA confirm. g4_b12 L2's generic "the said Castle of Anglesey" stands.
- "John Lewis" 4th body occurrence ✓ (g2_b12 L2).

✓ PRECISION RE-VERIFICATION COMPLETE — rows 1–12, all 48 cells read (2026-07-02, Fable 5)

Phase B of the precision pass. Rows 13–16 were already Fable-5 (grid pass + verification zooms) and were not re-read. Combined with Phase A (009) and Phase C (21 gap-zooms), **every membrane of STAC 8/203/38 now rests on Fable-5 readings**, and membranes 010 rows 1–12 no longer carry any Opus-era-only text. **Headline corrections this pass:** (1) the opening characterization is "very untrue and **scandalous**" with a proper demurrer formula ("for sundrie imperfections"); (2) the bill's purpose clause = **jury intimidation** — "**to stryke a feare into the harts** of all such **freeholders** ... retorned or **impannelled** for ... the try[a]lls of ... Bulkeley (whoe standeth indicted...) and of other the frends of..." (grid's "officers of the Chamber of England ... questioned or imprisoned" retracted); (3) the Answer twice denies plots with Barker, the second "**touchinge the callinge in question** of anie of the said p[er]sons ... in or upon the said Inditem[en]ts" — the manuscript uses Coke's later term of art; (4) the **£20 interlineation** ("not worthe xx li in all the worlde..."); (5) the keys narrative reversed (Lewis asked, Bulkeley refused); (6) dated appointment "ffebbruar[ie] Anno D[omi]ni 1605"; (7) the indictee list enlarged (Richard ap John, W[illia]m Prend[?], Richard ap Richard[?], Moris ap W[illia]m, Edward ap John) + murder place "the Rodwha[?]" + a struck first-draft name zone; (8) the reform passage is Barker-specific ("whose cominge into this Countrey"); (9) marginal cross at the Barker-denial line; (10) victim-token "Hughe ap W[illia]m [P/J]end[?]" ×5 (best candidate "P[ry]dd[e]").

✓ GRID PASS COMPLETE (rows 1–16, all 64 cells read) — 2026-07-01

The Answer runs: caption (Answer of **John Lewis**, one of the defendants, to the bill of **Rees/Rice ap Evan Lloyd**) → demurrer-style insufficiency objections + "untrue and fraudulent ... libelous" characterization + the

institutional-stakes clause ("all the officers ... shall be questioned or imprisoned") → Lewis's office (**High Sheriff of Anglesey** under Commission) → the jury return defended (freeholders, challenges heard, "openly and publicly sworn") → conviction "**upon good and pregnant proof**" before **Brereton + Barker** → the Lewis-returned jury found **William Bulkeley accessory before the fact** → denial of ANY plot/practice/confederacy with **Mr Justice Barker**, who "**used and behaved himself uprightly, indifferently**" → the bill branded "[a] devised and infamous bill ... against that reverent Justice," abuses "now (God be praised) well reformed" → the **castle-gaol custody dispute** (Sir Richard Bulkeley, Constable, holds the keys; prisoners are his "near friends ... and dependents"; escapes; Lewis removes prisoners **to his own house**, watched night and day at his own charge, until turned over to the new Sheriff) → the **office-fees answer** (bailiffs of hundreds, keeping of courts; "some small [fee] ... which was lawful ... as Sheriffs have used usually, and not otherwise") → aver-and-prove + **prayer to be dismissed with costs "most wrongfully sustained"** → foot: "6d" + counsel sig "**Boyd/Boys**".